

Referral fees and CPA rules

A short, plain-English note for accounting firms considering our partner program.

The short version

- ✓ If you perform attest services for a client — an audit, a review, an examination of prospective financial information, or a compilation whose report doesn't disclose a lack of independence — don't accept our fee for that client. Pass it to the client as a discount instead.
- ✓ For other clients, you may accept the fee if you disclose it to the client in writing. We provide a disclosure template.
- ✓ Some state boards of accountancy have stricter rules. Check yours.

Where this comes from

The AICPA Code of Professional Conduct covers commissions and referral fees (the "Commissions and Referral Fees" rule, ET 1.520). It limits commissions for recommending another company's products or services when you perform attest services for the client, and requires disclosure when a commission or referral fee is permitted. State boards adopt their own versions.

How our program is built around it

- Every referral fee can be turned into a client discount — at your choice, per client.
- We never offer accounting, tax or advisory services to your clients.
- Co-delivery is an alternative: you bill your own hours to your client, and no fee changes hands.

General information, not legal or ethics advice. Confirm your obligations with your state board and your professional liability insurer. Questions: Elena Sorel, hello@evenmont.com.